

CHECKLIST

Technical due diligence for investors

Eight things to check before money is committed to a software company. Most of them are not in the data room.

- ☐ **Source code ownership**
Where the code lives, who owns it, who has access, and whether founder and contractor IP was ever formally assigned.

- ☐ **Deployment process**
How releases are tested, approved, deployed, monitored and rolled back when something goes wrong.

- ☐ **Technical debt**
What slows delivery, creates fragility, increases security exposure or raises the future cost of change.

- ☐ **Security**
Authentication, access controls, secrets management, dependency risk, incident history and customer data exposure.

- ☐ **AI claims**
Whether AI features are proprietary, defensible, measurable and actually used in production workflows.

- ☐ **Key-person risk**
Whether one engineer, founder or agency holds critical operational knowledge.

- ☐ **Cloud costs**
Whether infrastructure spend is proportionate to revenue, usage, margins and the growth plan.

- ☐ **Documentation**
What exists for architecture, onboarding, incidents and operations, and how current it is.

The goal is not to find a perfect company. There are none. The goal is a priced view of the risk: which problems are normal, which are expensive, and which change the deal.

A red-flag review takes five to seven days. A full report takes two to three weeks. Every engagement runs under NDA.